

MATH40002 - Analysis I

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Chapter 1

Numbers and Sets

1.1 Introduction

In the introductory module (MATH40001), we constructed the number systems $\mathbb{N}$, $\mathbb{Z}$, $\mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbb{R}$. Real analysis focuses on the real numbers, $\mathbb{R}$, formalising many properties about functions that we know from calculus. For example, an intuitive notion of a continuous function is that you can draw the function on a piece of paper without taking your pen off the page. We make concepts like these precise in this module.

1.2 Countability

Before starting this chapter (and, in general, this module), it is imperative that you are familiar with the logic and sets part of the introductory module, MATH40001.

Definition 1.1. A set A is countably infinite if there exists a bijection $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow A$.

Intuitively, this says that you can list the elements of A as $a_1, a_2, \dots$ using only the natural numbers. We say that a set is *countable* if it is finite or countably infinite. Note we will take $\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, \dots\}$, unless stated otherwise.

Note that if there is a bijection between a given pair of sets A and B , then A is countable if and only if B is countable. This extends the natural idea of finite sets having the same number of elements if and only if there is a bijection between the sets. Formally, we define two sets having the same *cardinality* as follows:

Definition 1.2. Let A, B be sets. We say that A and B have the same cardinality if there exists a bijection $f : A \rightarrow B$.

The idea is that even in infinite settings, if we know a property about the 'size' of one set A , and there exists a bijection with another set B , then B shares this notion of 'size'. For example, as we mentioned, if such a bijection exists between two sets A, B , then A is countable if and only if B is countable. This gives rise to an equivalence relation, which we define as cardinality.

Exercise. Show that the relation $\sim$ on $\mathcal{P}(\mathcal{U})$ (where $\mathcal{U}$ is the universal set of interest) defined by $A \sim B \iff \exists f : A \rightarrow B$ such that f is a bijection, is an equivalence relation.

Theorem 1.3. If $A \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ is an infinite set, then A is countably infinite.

Proof. We construct a function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow A$ inductively: since A is nonempty, and $A \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, by well-ordering of the natural numbers we can pick $a_1 = \min A$, and let $f(1) = a_1$. Assume that, for $k \geq 1$, $a_1, \dots, a_k$ have been chosen and $f(i) = a_i$ for $1 \leq i \leq k$. Since A is infinite, $A \setminus \{a_1, \dots, a_k\}$ is nonempty. Pick $a_{k+1} = \min(A \setminus \{a_1, \dots, a_k\})$, and let $f(k+1) = a_{k+1}$. Thus by construction f is strictly increasing. We claim that f is a bijection.

- Injective: this holds because by construction f is strictly increasing. We saw in the introductory module that strictly increasing functions are injective.
- Surjective: suppose for contradiction that f is not surjective. Then there exists $a \in A$ such that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $f(n) \neq a$. Consider $A \setminus \{a\}$.

□

Lemma 1.4. *Let S be an infinite set. There exists an injection $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow S$.*

Proof. We construct a function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow S$ inductively: since S is infinite, it is nonempty, so we can pick $s_1 \in S$ and define $f(1) := s_1$. Suppose for $k \in \mathbb{N}$, $s_1, \dots, s_k$ have been chosen and we have defined $f(i) = s_i$ for $1 \leq i \leq k$. Since S is infinite, $S \setminus \{s_1, \dots, s_k\}$ is nonempty, so there is $s_{k+1} \in S \setminus \{s_1, \dots, s_k\}$. Define $f(k+1) := s_{k+1}$. By construction, if $i < j$ are natural numbers, then $s_j \in S \setminus \{s_1, \dots, s_{j-1}\}$ so $s_j \neq s_i$. So f is an injection. □

As a result, we can always *embed* the natural numbers into any infinite set via an injection $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow S$ (where S is any infinite set). In this way, the natural numbers can be thought of as ‘the smallest type of infinity’.

A not so surprising fact which we can prove immediately is that the set of integers, $\mathbb{Z}$, is countably infinite:

Theorem 1.5. *$\mathbb{Z}$ is countably infinite.*

Proof. Define $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ by

$$f(n) = \begin{cases} n/2, & \text{if } n \text{ even} \\ -(n+1)/2, & \text{if } n \text{ odd} \end{cases}$$

Then f is injective: suppose $f(a) = f(b)$. If a and b are of different parity then $f(a)$ and $f(b)$ are of different sign, so cannot be equal. So this case cannot happen. If a and b are even, then $a/2 = b/2$ so $a = b$. If a and b are odd, then $-(a+1)/2 = -(b+1)/2$ so $a = b$. So f is injective. Also, f is surjective: let $m \in \mathbb{Z}$ be arbitrary. If $m < 0$ then $f(-2m-1) = m$, and if $m \geq 0$ then $f(2m) = m$. Thus f is a bijection and $\mathbb{Z}$ is countable. □

Remark. This proof used a useful trick called interleaving, where we listed the integers as $0, -1, 1, -2, 2, \dots$, interleaving the negative and positive integers to create the desired bijection between $\mathbb{N}$ and $\mathbb{Z}$.

A less trivial fact is that the rational numbers, $\mathbb{Q}$, is countable. This may be hard to see until observing the proof of the following fact:

Theorem 1.6. *$\mathbb{N}^2$ is countably infinite.*

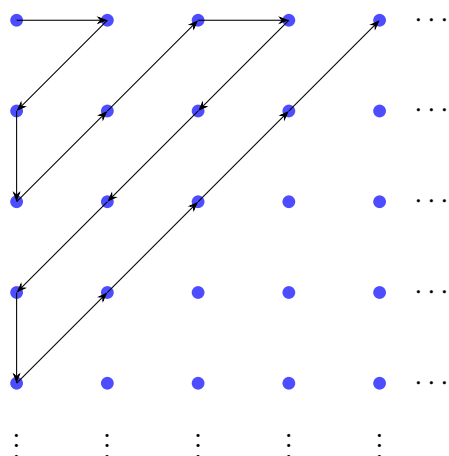


Figure 1.1: The diagonal listing of $\mathbb{N}^2$, showing it is countably infinite.

Proof. The idea is illustrated in the above diagram. Note that the listing goes

$$(0, 0), (0, 1), (1, 0), (2, 0), (1, 1), (0, 2), \dots$$

Notice that along each diagonal, $a + b$ is constant for all pairs (a, b) in that diagonal. This, along with the triangular number formula, provides the motivation for how to construct a bijection between $\mathbb{N}^2$ and $\mathbb{N}$.

Explicitly, define $f : \mathbb{N}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ by $f(a, b) = \frac{(a+b)(a+b+1)}{2} + b$. This is a bijection (exercise) so $\mathbb{N}^2$ is countable. Note that here we took $\mathbb{N} = \{0, 1, 2, \dots\}$. $\square$

As a consequence, we get:

Theorem 1.7. $\mathbb{Q}$ is countably infinite.

Proof. First we use Theorem 1.6 to show that $\mathbb{Q}_{\geq 0} := \{x \in \mathbb{Q} : x \geq 0\}$ is countably infinite. Let

$$S = \{(a, b) \in \mathbb{N}^2 : b \geq 1, \gcd(a, b) = 1\}.$$

Then $f : S \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}_{\geq 0}$, defined by $f(a, b) = a/b$ is a bijection because we know that all rational numbers in $\mathbb{Q}_{>0}$ take the unique form a/b where $b \geq 1$ and $\gcd(a, b) = 1$. Since $\mathbb{N}^2$ is countably infinite by Theorem 1.6, $S \subseteq \mathbb{N}^2$ is also countably infinite, so $\mathbb{Q}_{>0}$ is countably infinite.

It follows (exercise) that $\mathbb{Q}$ is countably infinite, using the same idea (interleaving) as the proof that $\mathbb{Z}$ is countably infinite. $\square$

Exercise. Finish the proof of Theorem 1.7. (*Hint:* use the fact that, by Theorem 1.6, there exists a bijection $h : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}_{>0}$).

The following lemma is a useful way of proving that a given set S is countably infinite without explicitly constructing a bijection $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow S$.

Lemma 1.8 (A criterion for countability). *Let S be an infinite set.*

1. S is countably infinite if and only if there exists an injection $\iota : S \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$.
2. S is countably infinite if and only if there exists a surjection $g : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow S$.

Proof. a □

The idea for item (1) above is that if you can *embed* your set into the natural numbers via an injection $\iota : S \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$, then it must be countably infinite, as $\iota(S) \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, and we have shown infinite subsets of $\mathbb{N}$ are countable, so since ι is an injection, S has the same cardinality as $\iota(S)$, (i.e. $S \sim \iota(S)$), so S is countably infinite. The idea for item (2) is similar: if you can use the natural numbers to list all the elements of your infinite set S , then even though this surjective map $g : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow S$ may not be injective, we have nonetheless listed all the elements of S using only the natural numbers, so S must be countably infinite also.

A simple example using Lemma 1.8 is that finite products of countable sets are countable (note that we already have the tools to prove this without Lemma 1.8 by using Theorem 1.6, which is a more elementary way of proving this fact via an explicit bijection).

Before looking at the example, try and think of properties of the integers that we can use to construct an injection $\iota : A \times B \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$.

Example 1.9. If A, B are countably infinite sets, then $A \times B$ is countably infinite.

Proof. Recall from the introductory module that we define

$$A \times B := \{(a, b) : a \in A, b \in B\}.$$

Since A and B are countably infinite, let $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow A, g : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow B$ be bijections. Therefore, we can write $A = \{a_1, a_2, \dots\}$ and $B = \{b_1, b_2, \dots\}$. Define $\iota : A \times B \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ by $\iota(a_i, b_j) = 2^i 3^j$. By the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic from the introductory module, ι is an injection because prime factorisations are unique, so by Lemma 1.8, $A \times B$ is countably infinite. □

This trick of mapping each element of the set to a prime factorisation is useful to keep in mind, as it is a very neat way of proving countability for sets.

Not all sets are countably infinite:

Definition 1.10. An infinite set is called *uncountable* if it is not countably infinite.

For example, the set of real numbers $\mathbb{R}$ is uncountable. To show this, we first prove:

Lemma 1.11. The set $(0, 1) := \{x \in \mathbb{R} : 0 < x < 1\}$ is uncountable.

Proof. The main technique that we use in arguing why a given set is uncountable is *Cantor's diagonal argument*, which goes like this. Suppose, for contradiction, that $(0, 1)$ is countably infinite. Then there exists a bijection $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow (0, 1)$ (note here we will let $\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, \dots\}$ for aesthetics; the argument does not change). For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we write $f(n) = x_n = 0.a_{1n}a_{2n}\dots$, writing each x_n in decimal form, excluding tails of the digit 9 (for example, $0.8999\dots = 0.9$). We now get a listing of the numbers in $(0, 1)$ which looks like:

$$\begin{aligned} f(1) &= 0.a_{11}a_{12}a_{13}a_{14}\dots \\ f(2) &= 0.a_{21}a_{22}a_{23}a_{24}\dots \\ f(3) &= 0.a_{31}a_{32}a_{33}a_{34}\dots \\ f(4) &= 0.a_{41}a_{42}a_{43}a_{44}\dots \\ &\vdots \end{aligned}$$

The idea is that we look at the *diagonal* elements, a_{ii} for $i \geq 1$, and construct a number $x \in (0, 1)$ such that for all $i \geq 1$, the i^{th} decimal place of x differs from the i^{th} decimal place of $f(i)$,

thereby constructing a number $x \in (0, 1)$ that is not in the enumeration f of the interval $(0, 1)$, which is a contradiction to f being surjective. We construct $x \in (0, 1)$ as follows: for $j \geq 1$, let b_j be the j^{th} decimal place of x , then we define

$$b_j = \begin{cases} 2 & \text{if } a_{jj} = 1 \\ 1 & \text{if } a_{jj} \neq 1 \end{cases}$$

Then by construction, $b_i \neq a_{ii}$ for each $i \geq 1$, so in particular (by uniqueness of decimal representations under our restriction to decimal expansions with no digit 9 tails), we have $x \neq f(i)$ for all $i \geq 1$, so $x \in (0, 1)$ is not in the image of f , a contradiction to f being surjective onto $(0, 1)$. Therefore, $(0, 1)$ is uncountable. $\square$

Theorem 1.12. $\mathbb{R}$ is uncountable.

Proof. Follows from Lemma 1.11 (exercise). $\square$

Exercise. Find a bijection $f : (0, 1) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, and deduce that $\mathbb{R}$ is an uncountable set.

Chapter 2

Sequences and Series

2.1 Sequences

Definition 2.1. A real sequence is a function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$.

In general, $\mathbb{R}$ can be replaced by a metric space X , for example the complex numbers $\mathbb{C}$ which we will see later. It is therefore important to distinguish *real* sequences. For notation, we will write $(a_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ to denote a sequence $a_1, a_2, \dots$, and sometimes this will be shortened to (a_n) , or just a_n .

2.1.1 Convergence of sequences

Intuitively, a real sequence converges to a limit $L \in \mathbb{R}$ if we can make the terms of our sequence, a_n , arbitrarily close to L , whenever we go far enough out into the sequence. Clearly, this does not suffice as a mathematical definition, so instead we define convergence of a real sequence (a_n) as follows.

Definition 2.2 (Convergence of a sequence). A real sequence (a_n) converges to $L \in \mathbb{R}$ if

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0, \exists N \in \mathbb{N}, \forall n \geq N, |a_n - L| < \varepsilon$$

For notation, if Definition 2.2 holds for a sequence (a_n) , we will write $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} a_n = L$, which we will sometimes shorten to $a_n \rightarrow L$ (as $n \rightarrow \infty$) or $\lim a_n = L$, if from the context it is clear we are talking about a sequence, and not, say, a limit of a function $f(x)$ (which, as we will see, does not have to be the limit as $x \rightarrow \infty$).

Example 2.3. Use Definition 2.2 to show that the sequence (a_n) defined by $a_n = 1/n$ for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$ converges to 0.

Proof. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ be arbitrary. Choose $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $N > 1/\varepsilon$ (such an N exists by the Archimedean property of the real numbers from the introductory module). Then, given $n \geq N$, we have

$$|a_n - 0| = 1/n \leq 1/N < \varepsilon,$$

so $a_n \rightarrow 0$. □

Definition 2.4. A sequence *diverges* if it does not converge.

Definition 2.5. A real sequence (a_n) is bounded if there exists $M > 0$ such that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $|a_n| \leq M$.

Remark. Note that a real sequence can diverge but still be bounded (see below).

Example 2.6. Use Definition 2.2 to show that the sequence $a_n := (-1)^n$ diverges.

Proof. Suppose for contradiction that $a_n \rightarrow L \in \mathbb{R}$. Let $N \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that for all $n \geq N$,

$$|(-1)^n - L| < 1/2.$$

But also, by the triangle inequality,

$$2 = |(-1)^{2N} - (-1)^{2N+1}| \leq |(-1)^{2N} - L| + |L - (-1)^{2N+1}| < 1/2 + 1/2 = 1,$$

which is a contradiction. Therefore, (a_n) diverges. $\square$

2.1.2 Basic results on convergent sequences

Unsurprisingly, if a sequence converges to a limit, then it must be unique:

Theorem 2.7. *Limits of convergent sequences are unique.*

Proof. Suppose $a_n \rightarrow L$ and $a_n \rightarrow M$, and let $\varepsilon > 0$ be arbitrary. We wish to conclude that $L = M$. By convergence of $a_n \rightarrow L$, pick $N_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $n \geq N_1$, $|a_n - L| < \varepsilon/2$. By convergence of $a_n \rightarrow M$ let $N_2 \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that for all $n \geq N_2$, $|a_n - M| < \varepsilon/2$. Now, let $n := \max\{N_1, N_2\}$. By the triangle inequality, we have

$$|L - M| = |L - a_n + a_n - M| \leq |a_n - L| + |a_n - M| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon.$$

Therefore, since ε was arbitrary, $L = M$ (to see this, if $L \neq M$ then one can pick $\varepsilon = |L - M|/2$ and get a contradiction). $\square$

Theorem 2.8 (Order limit theorem). *Suppose (a_n) and (b_n) are two real sequences such that $a_n \geq b_n$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Let $a_n \rightarrow a$ and $b_n \rightarrow b$. Then $a \geq b$.*

Proof. Suppose for contradiction that $a < b$. Pick $\varepsilon = \frac{b-a}{2}$. Since $a_n \rightarrow a$, there exists $N_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $n \geq N_1$, $|a_n - a| < \varepsilon$, so in particular for $n \geq N_1$,

$$a_n < a + \varepsilon = a + \frac{b-a}{2} = \frac{a+b}{2},$$

and since $b_n \rightarrow b$ there exists $N_2 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $n \geq N_2$, $|b_n - b| < \varepsilon$, so in particular for $n \geq N_2$,

$$b_n > b - \varepsilon = b - \frac{b-a}{2} = \frac{a+b}{2}.$$

Therefore, choosing $n := \max\{N_1, N_2\}$ it follows that $b_n > a_n$, which is a contradiction. $\square$

Corollary 2.9. Suppose (a_n) is a real sequence with $a_n \rightarrow a$ such that $B \leq a_n \leq C$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then $B \leq a \leq C$.

Proof. Apply Theorem 2.8 using constant sequences $b_n = B$ and $c_n = C$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. $\square$

Remark. If $B < a_n < C$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ in the above corollary, it is not necessarily true that $B < a < C$, but we do still get the non-strict inequalities $B \leq a \leq C$. Limits only preserve non-strict inequalities.

Theorem 2.10. Convergent sequences are bounded.

Proof. Let (a_n) be a convergent sequence, and let $L \in \mathbb{R}$ be such that $\lim a_n = L$. Let $N \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that for all $n \geq N$, $|a_n - L| < 1$. In other words, for all $n \geq N$ we have

$$a_n \in (L - 1, L + 1).$$

Now, pick $M := \max\{|a_1|, |a_2|, \dots, |a_{N-1}|, |L| + 1\}$. Then by construction, $|a_n| \leq M$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, so (a_n) is bounded. $\square$

Remark. The idea for the above proof is that we can control (a_n) to be close to L (say, within a distance of 1 from L), past some point $N \in \mathbb{N}$, and before that, there are only finitely many terms in the sequence, so we can just take the maximum of a finite number of terms $|a_1|, \dots, |a_{N-1}|$, and then include $|L| + 1$ to complete the bound.

Similarly to the above observation, changing a finite number of terms in a convergent sequence does not affect its convergence. When dealing with convergence of sequences, we only care about the behaviour of the *tail* of the sequence. This motivates the following definition:

Definition 2.11. A sequence (a_n) *eventually* has a property P if there exists $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $n \geq N$, a_n has property P .

Remark. Modifying the hypothesis of a theorem which requires a property of a sequence to hold for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ with *eventually* does not weaken the theorem; they are equivalent.

Example 2.12. Let the property P be 'constant'. The sequence $a_1 = 1, a_2 = 2$ and $a_n = 0$ for all $n \geq 3$ is *eventually* constant.

Exercise. Prove that if an integer sequence (a_n) (that is, $a_n \in \mathbb{Z}$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$) converges, then it is eventually constant.

Definition 2.13. Let (a_n) be a real sequence.

- A sequence $a_n \rightarrow \infty$ if for every $R > 0$, a_n is eventually greater than R .
- A sequence $a_n \rightarrow -\infty$ if for every $R < 0$, a_n is eventually less than R .

Example 2.14. 1. $a_n = n^2 \rightarrow \infty$. Indeed, let $R > 0$, and take $n > \sqrt{R}$. Then

$$a_n = n^2 > (\sqrt{R})^2 = R$$

2. Define

$$a_n = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } n \text{ odd} \\ n & \text{if } n \text{ even} \end{cases}$$

This is an example of a sequence which does not diverge to ∞ , but is unbounded (as an exercise, use Definition 2.13 to prove this directly).

Changing a finite number of terms in a convergent sequence does not affect convergence:

Lemma 2.15. *Let $K \in \mathbb{N}$ be arbitrary. Then $(a_n)_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is a convergent sequence with limit $L \in \mathbb{R}$ if and only if $(a_{n+K})_{n=1}^{\infty}$ is a convergent sequence, with limit $L \in \mathbb{R}$.*

Proof. Suppose (a_n) converges to $L \in \mathbb{R}$. Pick $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $n \geq N$, $|a_n - L| < \varepsilon$. Since $K \geq 0$, given $n \geq N$, $n + K \geq n \geq N$, so $|a_{n+K} - L| < \varepsilon$.

Conversely, suppose (a_{n+K}) converges to $L \in \mathbb{R}$. Let $N \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that for all $n \geq N$, $|a_{n+K} - L| < \varepsilon$. Choose $N' := N + K$. Given $n \geq N'$, we have $n \geq N + K$, so for $n \geq N'$, $|a_n - L| < \varepsilon$. $\square$

2.1.3 The Algebraic Limit Theorem

There is a useful theorem that allows us to avoid ε proofs and use convergence results that we have already proven:

Theorem 2.16 (Algebraic limit theorem). *Let (a_n) , and (b_n) be real sequences, and suppose $a_n \rightarrow a \in \mathbb{R}$, and $b_n \rightarrow b \in \mathbb{R}$. Then*

1. $a_n + b_n \rightarrow a + b$.
2. $a_n b_n \rightarrow ab$.
3. For all $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, $\lambda a_n \rightarrow \lambda a$.
4. If $b_n \neq 0$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $b \neq 0$, then $1/b_n \rightarrow 1/b$.

Proof. (1) and (3) are good exercises to practice using Definition 2.2.

- (2) Case 1: without loss of generality, suppose that $a \neq 0$ and $b = 0$; let $\varepsilon > 0$ be arbitrary. By Theorem 2.10, there exists $M > 0$ such that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $|a_n| \leq M$. By convergence of $b_n \rightarrow 0$, let $N \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that for all $n \geq N$, $|b_n| < \varepsilon/M$. Then for $n \geq N$, we have

$$|a_n b_n| = |a_n| |b_n| \leq M |b_n| < M(\varepsilon/M) = \varepsilon,$$

so $a_n b_n \rightarrow 0$.

Case 2: Suppose that $a \neq 0$ and $b \neq 0$; let $\varepsilon > 0$ be arbitrary. By Theorem 2.10 let $M > 0$ be such that for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $|a_n| \leq M$. By convergence of $a_n \rightarrow a$, let $N_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that for all $n \geq N_1$, $|a_n - a| < \varepsilon/2|b|$. Also, by convergence of $b_n \rightarrow b$, let $N_2 \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that

for all $n \geq N_2$, $|b_n - b| < \varepsilon/2M$. Choose $N := \max\{N_1, N_2\}$. Then for all $n \geq N$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} |a_n b_n - ab| &= |a_n b_n - a_n b + a_n b - ab| \\ &\leq |a_n b_n - a_n b| + |a_n b - ab| \\ &= |a_n||b_n - b| + |b||a_n - a| \\ &\leq M|b_n - b| + |b||a_n - a| \\ &< M\left(\frac{\varepsilon}{2M}\right) + |b|\left(\frac{\varepsilon}{2|b|}\right) \\ &= \varepsilon, \end{aligned}$$

so $a_n b_n \rightarrow ab$.

- (4) Let $\varepsilon > 0$ be arbitrary. Let $N_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that for all $n \geq N_1$, $|b_n - b| < |b|/2$, so by the triangle inequality we have, for $n \geq N_1$,

$$|b| = |b - b_n + b_n| \leq |b_n - b| + |b_n| < \frac{|b|}{2} + |b_n| \implies |b_n| > \frac{|b|}{2} > 0.$$

Now, let $N_2 \in \mathbb{N}$ be such that for all $n \geq N_2$, $|b_n - b| < \frac{\varepsilon|b|^2}{2}$. Choose $N := \max\{N_1, N_2\}$. For all $n \geq N$, we have

$$\left| \frac{1}{b_n} - \frac{1}{b} \right| = \frac{|b_n - b|}{|b||b_n|} < \frac{|b_n - b|}{|b|^2/2} < \frac{\varepsilon|b|^2/2}{|b|^2/2} = \varepsilon,$$

so $1/b_n \rightarrow 1/b$. □

Remark. Using items (2) and (4) above, it follows that if $b \neq 0$ and $b_n \neq 0$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and $a_n \rightarrow a$, $b_n \rightarrow b$, then $a_n/b_n \rightarrow a/b$.

Example 2.17. 1. $a_n = \frac{n^2+4n+1}{2n^2+1} \rightarrow \frac{1}{2}$. For $n \in \mathbb{N}$ we have

$$a_n = \frac{1 + 4/n + 1/n^2}{2 + 1/n^2}.$$

Now, using (2) in Theorem 2.16, $1/n^2 \rightarrow 0$ since we have shown $1/n \rightarrow 0$, and using (1), (3), (4) we get $\lim a_n = \frac{1}{2}$.

2. Applying (2) inductively, since $1/n \rightarrow 0$ we get that for any $m \in \mathbb{N}$, $1/n^m \rightarrow 0$.

2.1.4 Monotone convergence theorem

Definition 2.18. Let (a_n) be a real sequence.

1. We say that a_n is *increasing* if for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $a_{n+1} \geq a_n$. If the inequality is strict for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we say that a_n is *strictly increasing*.
2. We say that a_n is *decreasing* if for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $a_{n+1} \leq a_n$. If the inequality is strict for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we say that a_n is *strictly decreasing*.

Example 2.19. The sequence $a_n = 1/n$ is strictly decreasing and converges to 0, the sequence $a_n = 1 - 1/n$ is strictly increasing and converges to 1, the sequence $a_n = n$ is strictly increasing and diverges to ∞ , and the sequence $a_n = (-1)^n n$ is neither strictly increasing nor strictly decreasing, and diverges.

We now state and prove an important theorem about monotonic and bounded real sequences.

Theorem 2.20 (Monotone convergence theorem). *Let (a_n) be a bounded and monotone real sequence. Then (a_n) is convergent.*

Proof. We will prove the case where a_n is increasing. The case where a_n is decreasing is similar, and is left as an exercise. $\square$

Chapter 3

Limits and Continuity

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